

‘Uloom Al Hadith Terminology

Types of Narrations:

Hadith حديث: Refers back to the Prophet (SAW)

Khabar خبر: Refers back to the Sahabah

Athar اثر: Refers back to later generations

Above 3 are interchangeable

Sunnah سنة: Exclusive to the Prophet (SAW)

‘Uloom Al Hadith Branches:

Riwayah رواية: Face value information we have about the Hadith

Dirayah دراية: Understanding and application of the Hadith

Parts of a Hadith:

Sanad سند: Chain of narration of the hadith

Matn متن: Wording of the hadith

Types of Hadith Collections:

Al Sahifah الصحيفة: Small personal booklet of hadith from the sahabah

Al Musannaf المصنف: categorized by topic and includes narrations from the Prophet (SAW), Sahabah and Tabi'i

Al Musnad المسند: Compiled by the order of Sahabah

Al Jami' الجامع: Comprehensive; includes all major topics addressed in Hadith (Aqeedah, Ahkam, Siyar, Adab, Tafsir, Signs of the day of judgment, fitan, virtues of the companions)

Sunan سنن: Organized based on chapters of fiqh starting from taharah

Al Mu'jam المعجم: Alphabetical order

Al Mustadrak المستدرک: Supplements work based on same conditions

Al Mustakhraj المستخرج: Brings the same hadith with a different chain

Al Juz الجز: a mini collection on a specific topic

Al Sharh الشرح: commentary on hadith

About Hadith Narrators:

Ilm Al Rijal علم الرجال: Biography of Narrators

Al Jarh الجرح: Criticism

Al Ta'dil التعديل: Validation

Thiqat ثقة: Reliability

Al ‘Adalah العدالة: Moral character

Al Dabt الضبط: Precision and memory accuracy in narration

The End of the Chain:

Hadith Qudsi الحديث القدسي: The prophet (SAW) saying “Allah said”, the end of the chain is going to be Allah

Hadith Al Marfu' الحديث المرفوع: Statement of the Prophet (SAW) and the Prophet (SAW) will be at the end of the chain

Hadith Al Mawquf الحديث الموقوف: a statement with the sahabah being at the end of the chain

Hadith Al Maqtu' الحديث المقطوع: a statement and the end of the chain is a tabi'i or anyone after

Number of Narrators-Mutawatir:

Mutawatir متواتر: Mass transmission, more than 4-100 narrators

Mutawatir Al Lafzi متواتر اللفظي: Statements of the Prophet (SAW) with exact wording

Mutawatir Al Ma'nawi متواتر المعنوي: Statements of the Prophet (SAW) with the same meaning but different wording

Number of Narrators:

Al Aahaad الأحاد: did not reach mass transmission

Khabar Aahaad خبر الأحاد: Does not fulfill the standard of mutawatir

Al Mashoor المشهور: at least 3 narrators at every level of the chain, not high enough for mutawatir

Al 'Aziz العزيز: exactly 2 narrators at every level of the chain

Al Ghareeb الغريب: exactly 1 narrator at every level of the chain

Al Ghareeb Al Mutlaq الغريب المطلق: one narrator at every level of the chain

Al Ghareeb Al Nisbi الغريب النسبي: one narrator at a specific level in the chain

Al Mustafeed المستفيض: Begins at a low number of narrators to growing very large throughout the generations

Classification Based on Strength:

Maqbul مقبول: Accepted

Sahih Lizatihi صحيح لذاته: authentic on its own

Sahih Lighayrihi صحيح لغيره: authentic due to external factor

Itissal Al Sanad اتصال السند: continuous chain

Tadlees تبليس: when someone is skipped purposely in a chain

'Adm Al Shuzuz عدم الشذوذ: not contradictory

'Adm Al 'ila عدم العلة: absent of defects

Hasan Lizatihi حسن لذاته: sound hadith on its own

Hasan Lighayrihi حسن لغيره: sound hadith due to external factors

Classification Based on Weakness:

Mardood مردود: Not accepted

Da'if ضعيف: Weak

Munqati' منقطع: general word for a broken chain

Mu'allaq معلق: when you mention a hadith without a chain of narration

Mursal مرسل: when a hadith is mentioned by a tabi'i but skips a sahabah and goes straight to the Prophet (SAW)

Mursal al Sahabi مرسل الصحابي: when a sahabah skips another sahabah [authentic]

Mu'dal معضل: when 2 people in a row are skipped in a chain no matter how far in the chain

Mawdu' موضوع: known to have lied about hadith whether its this one or not

Matruk متروك: someone who was accused of lying

Munkar منكر: either dabt/'adalah is really bad OR a weak narrator contradicting an authentic one

Shadh شاذ: both narrators are strong but contradicts a more reliable narrator

Mafulz مفوز: the more reliable narrator

Mu'allal معلل: when there is a hidden علة [defect] in the hadith

Mudraj مدرج: when a narrator inserts something in the narration and it is hard to detect who is saying what

Maqlub مقلوب: a chain of narration that is out of order OR the wording of hadith is out of order

Mudtarib مضطرب: a narration narrated in 2 ways by 2 narrators of the same level but with completely opposite meanings

Musahhaf مصحف: if someone misreads or writes incorrectly a hadith because of the harakat